

Private Worship - The Fellowship Gift

The Anointing of Truth Guards Against Seduction

Sometimes I only have three things to say: hallelujah, glory, Jesus. I keep it short.

John said, concerning those who seduce you, that you have no need that any man teach you, because the anointing you have received is truth and cannot lie. There is something about it that teaches you all things.

He called it an anointing of truth.

Just one arrow, one dart, tries to penetrate the shield. The devil's greatest effectiveness is deception and strongholds, systems of thought empowered by emotion. But once the Holy Ghost establishes Himself in you as Teacher, not one of those darts will get by.

John was not doing away with teachers. He said this concerning those who deceive you. If your deception is being born from the pulpit, what is your defense?

You have Bibles sitting in your laps now. You can check everything that is said. But there are men who have memorized the whole Old and New Testament and still do not know what it means.

In the early church, the same circumstances were not in place. If you could afford a scroll, you would have to be like the Ethiopian eunuch under Candace, who was over her treasury and had a copy of Isaiah. When the gospel began to spread to the Gentile church, the masses were pagan, and many could not read. Traveling ministries were often the sole diet people had.

Someone had to go do a work and stay there until it was established. After you heard what you heard, you went home. Who did you have to depend on?

That is why John taught that concerning those who seduce you, you have no need that any man teach you. That anointing, which is truth and cannot lie, teaches you all things.

The way it works is this: when deception is in play and unfolding, that anointing of truth teaches you what is truth and what is not, who is teaching wrong and who is not.

Once the Holy Ghost establishes Himself in you as Teacher, not a single dart can get by.

Intellect Helps Only When It Submits to the Holy Spirit

What generally happens to people is that the Holy Ghost has not been able to establish Himself in them as Teacher. Once He began illuminating them, there were doctrinal errors they continued to hold on to. Because He could not clean up those areas, it was hard for Him to inoculate them against other areas of deception.

But once you let Him take over the whole pie, He can guard the whole thing.

A man who is at the mercy of his own intellect is vulnerable. To have a high intellect that is a total servant to the Word is to be like Paul. There is no use running around bragging about a lack of knowledge. Yes, God can take someone who cannot read and use him to shake a nation, and we will always preach on that as a testimony that it had to be God. But that does not give you license to belittle knowledge.

He would use Einstein if Einstein would let Him.

Knowledge is the fuel that wisdom burns.

A giant intellect is not an inoculation against deception. It is a key to knowledge, and if knowledge is subjected to the Holy Spirit, then knowledge becomes fuel for wisdom.

If I really wanted to get rich the way many preachers preach it, I have it figured out. They say if I give a hundred dollars, I will get a hundredfold back. Have you ever calculated that out? If that works for them, then I do not need them. I will just give my own hundred and be rich the rest of my life.

What am I missing? Do I not fit into the equation?

I understand what drove some men into error. A high IQ is not an inoculation against deception. Many high-IQ teachers tend to lean eventually toward ultimate reconciliation, ultimate salvation, once saved always saved, or Calvinism and the sovereignty of salvation.

If a person does not bring his reasonings under subjection to the Holy Spirit and let Him guide them, then the one thing a giant intellect is good at is reasoning. They reason into certain areas and begin trying to figure out that God is good. They go into the Old Testament and struggle with some of God's actions under the law. They reason and reason until they come up with their own conclusions.

Some finally preach that everybody is going to be saved. Ultimate reconciliation even includes the devil when everything is over. That is a nice thought, but when someone asks, "What is the point of serving God in a system like that?" the answer becomes, "Well, unbelievers do not receive anything from Him now. They are not under blessing. But ultimately they will be saved."

That is basically their answer.

Praying in Tongues Kept Returning Me to the Right Trail

This is my thirty-first year, and I have preached what I knew. One reason He kept getting me off the trails of error is the revelation gift of praying in tongues.

No matter what kind of hell came against me, when the dust cleared, I always went back to the closet. I got taken out a few times for certain amounts of time, but I always returned to the prayer closet.

In those areas, I could not find a teacher who could explain to me what was happening when I prayed. Neither could I find anyone who could really explain what happened when God plunged me into private worship.

I knew I was supposed to do what He told me to do, and that is the only thing that kept me in there through the hard times when private worship did not seem to produce what people said it would.

People made it sound like worship would instantly cause you to leap for joy and pull you out of everything. They said your days would turn to dancing through flowers.

But I spent weeks and weeks in worship so dry that if the worship words had been cooked into hotcakes, they would have been flat on the floor. I would have needed a spatula to get under those flat words of worship and flip them over.

The only reason I stayed in there was because praying in tongues had dropped me off on the worship limb, and I had received my first set of instructions. I knew God well enough to know, "Do not come out. Something is happening."

After about six weeks of dry, fighting private worship, a little voice came to a conclusion in me: "This is something you have to get past. You are building yourself up above this. This is a place you used to walk, and you are not going to walk here anymore."

He started talking to me. This is why hardly anybody breaks into those areas. They hardly ever get past the dark places.

The Hardest Worship Is Often the Strongest Breakthrough

For those who want to walk in His power, who want to challenge things at gut level, face them down, and make them get out of your life and circumstances, you need to know this: some of the highest times you are getting through in private worship, the strongest times, are when it feels the worst.

You may think the highest worship is when your feelings, senses, and emotions are dripping with honey, when you are dancing through a rose garden and everything is perfect. But anybody can worship God then.

When everything is flowing nicely in private worship, that is glorious. But when the world lands on you, every nation in it declares war on you, and there is nothing left to go wrong, that is when worship becomes a battleground.

I once heard of someone whose circumstances were so bad that you would have to think a long time to invent anything else that could happen. She just took a big breath and said, "I have it pretty good."

"Why?"

"I am not in hell, am I?"

That is a good point. If you are not in hell right now, you have a pretty good chance of making it.

Private Worship Lets You Choose the Battleground

You often wonder how strong you really are. Suppose you are walking down a trail in old Mexico or Africa, and someone jumps out of the brush with his face painted, wearing a little grass skirt, running at you with a machete. That is no time to stop and question whether you are called to be a missionary.

You wonder where your faith would be in a situation like that. Would it become a two-hundred-mile-an-hour dash?

Let me give you safer ground to test your faith on. The victories are incredible there too, and the consequences, if you abort, may be more devastating in the long run, though not so apparent at first.

If you want a place to test your ground, stay in worship. Stay in His presence and challenge your flesh. Go into the jungle of your flesh and challenge it.

If you really want to fight some witch doctors, discipline yourself for about four hours. Then the witch doctors of the flesh that holds back anointing will come. You will have a war. You may rather be chased by a man with a machete.

After a while, you look at your watch. What good does that do? You still have three hours and forty-five minutes left, and it is as dry as yesterday.

It is a good place to challenge unbelief, lack of anointing, the jungle of your flesh, reasonings, and everything in you that is undisciplined.

I can see the look on some of your faces: "Can you just do this for us?"

No.

Remember the prophecy: He cannot love Himself in you for you.

First you receive His love and let it become part of you. Then, because you are operating in that love, you turn around and with everything you are, you love Him back.

He cannot do that for you.

He has enough trouble getting you just to receive the love He has for you. "God really loves me." Yes, but it would be nice if you would receive some of it.

"I am receiving it."

Are you walking in it?

"Everybody around me is ugly."

Does that give you an excuse to be ugly?

Uncommon Ground Requires Warning People About the War

This is uncommon ground you are challenging. How do I know? Because I do not see the results of it in many places.

You can be in the trial of your life and surrender yourself to it, or you can be in the best time of your life and surrender yourself to it. Then you will have the trial.

Many people do not do this because they are uninformed. If you do not tell people that they are going to hit some kind of turn-back war, you do them a disservice and help take them out of the path.

Somebody is supposed to go over to the other side of the river, bring the grapes back, and say, "There are giants over there, but you should see the fruit."

When Israel saw that cluster of grapes that took two men to carry, they had to fight a war and leave a nation of unbelief behind. If someone came back with fruit like that, I think I would go. I would not care if there were giants in the land.

What I like about this walk is that eventually I learned I could choose my own battleground. I am not waiting until the man with the machete runs out. I choose my own battleground by inflicting torment on the devil. I choose my battleground by doing things he knows will not leave me the same.

I am not going to stay the same. Next year I will be different than I am this year. I will defeat him in every realm I enter, in every piece of God I receive that I did not have before. He will go to war to make sure I do not go there, but I do not care. I am choosing my battleground.

I am going to fight him until he comes after me, and then I am going to whip him out.

Private Worship Is the Fellowship Gift That Reveals the Father

He wants you to remember and know what happens in private worship, just that limb.

I thought it had to do with receiving from God and things like that. It does, but really it is a fellowship gift. It is a gift that brings you to know the Father in a way I had not known Him in thirty years. I do not know anybody who knows Him that way by taking an alternative route.

I know people who know Him well. I know people who shook nations in religious circles and then aborted and lost much of their reward because of deception they entered into in their last days.

What I am finding is that on this worship limb, there is a gifting, something He gave to us through our new nature. It says, "This is what can bring you into My presence and sustain you until you know Me in My inner workings. Your fellowship with Me will be around truth. In this fellowship, son, this is where all those things I said are possible to him who believes."

I knew people who worshiped more than others and received a certain level, then stopped.

Here is why He diverted me: He wants you to understand that when things could not get any worse, you are not failing to get through. In fact, you are getting through more when you feel it less.

You are not going to spend several hours worshiping and feeling nothing unless you are engaged in some kind of war that succeeded in stopping you before with the ammunition it had. I am not talking about stopping you merely from worshiping God. I am talking about stopping you from entering into that place with Him where the things you see, believe for, and want to walk in start becoming reality.

So keep this in mind when you take on the worship limb: keep taking it on until you win.

The pleasant times are nice. He loves you, and He will visit you like that. But when you are moving mountains, it is because there are mountains to move.

The Peace of Fellowship Is Beyond Natural Vocabulary

Since I won in those long seasons of private worship, I have not lapsed back into a war that was almost unbearable. I think I saw the last of that war, unless there is something bigger God wants to do and a bigger devil I have not met.

But He keeps wanting to exhort you for two reasons. He wants you to know Him, and He wants to fellowship with you. Both of you are going to be better for it.

You are better because His presence changes your life when you start knowing Him like this. He is blessed because He gets from you the kind of fellowship you were originally born for in Adam. He gets that from you before you get there, and you get Him here.

That is a pretty good deal.

You cannot wallow in that peace and love for any amount of time without it translating into peace. Every time one of us tries to describe the peace we are entering into, we try to compare it to the peace we had before, which we could not describe either. Then when you go higher, you try to describe that.

Jesus said, "My peace I give unto you," and that peace is not of this world. That is one reason you have such trouble describing it. Most of your vocabulary originated in this world, and you are trying to use those words for spiritual things. You are trying to describe something that is not in this world, and you are limited in your articulation.

Tongues Can Deliver You to Keys It Cannot Replace

Why would He say, "Worship Me in spirit and in truth"?

When He first laid me out and told me, "You know nothing about worship," I said, "Yes, but I am on a nine-day fast." That was my defense.

He said, "Fasting cannot give you what private worship does. When you major on just one key, you will have an imbalanced ministry, and I will never be able to do My fullness for you."

Then I felt bad about praying in tongues because I had majored on that. He said, "Fortunately, you were illuminated by the key that is a revelation gift."

But tongues cannot give you what private worship does, nor can it give you what fasting does. It can deliver you to those things, and those things will give you what they carry.

I remember one year I passed private worship up. Praying in tongues delivered me to it, but I saw what was being taught on it and did not like some of it, so I passed it up. I went on one more year, and then I landed on the floor by the dove, with Him telling me, "You do not know anything about worship."

Number one, I had passed the worship limb up. Number two, I would not quit praying in tongues. So it obligated Him to pick me up on the path and put me back on private worship.

He said, "You are not going where you are going unless you include this limb."

"What do You want me to do?"

He told me the hours and everything. About three weeks later, I was in there ready to die.

"Glory. Am I speaking to the fathomless depths of outer space where there are no human beings? Hallelujah. God, I thought You and I had something going. Where are You now?"

I am giving you some of the worst scenarios, but you have it pretty good running around in your air-conditioned cars.

Worship Lets You Love Him Back From the New Birth

Nothing about your first birth is equal, unless you were born to believing parents who knew how to believe. Some people are born without arms or legs. Nothing about the first birth is equal.

It is your second birth where you come out of God as a new creation, born again with His nature, with the same rights everyone else has in God's family.

Once you are born again, you can bring yourself onto the equal playing field. All you have to do is get to know Him who gave you that life, whose son you have become.

Brother Coker, after one hundred forty hours of private worship, jumped off the bed and said, "If You are not getting anything out of this, I have better things to do." He no sooner got that out than he collapsed into weeping and crying. It took him forty-five minutes just to tell his son what happened. It revolutionized his life and changed his marriage. Ask his wife. She said, "I have another husband now."

He cannot love Himself in you for you. But when it changes you, you can stand up in His truth and give that love back to Him.

Part of worshiping Him in truth is to receive a truth He has given, such as "All things are possible to him that believeth," and receive it so completely that part of your worship is to go out and administer that truth, get people free, and present them back to Him free because you believed His truth.

There is nothing in your body, life, or finances stronger than the redemption sealed by Jesus' blood through the eternal Spirit.

Jesus' Blood Purchased Everything the Father Has for You

Under the shadow, with an animal, the life was in the blood. Shed the blood, and the animal died. When they caught a beast in the field, the instruction they received from Noah was, "You may eat it, its life for yours, but pour the blood out."

Later, under the Levitical priesthood, they could not eat the blood. The atonement was in the blood, because under the shadow it was a type of Jesus' blood, which spoke of His eternal spirit.

There is nothing in the Father that Jesus has not purchased. There is nothing He has not redeemed me out of and into.

When Scripture says "through His blood" or "by His blood," He offered Himself through the eternal spirit. The part that was really offered was His human spirit, the part able to die. He received my death into Himself.

People want to argue that Jesus did not die spiritually. In a manner of speaking, He did not die because of sin. He became the sin. There is a difference. That death nature and everything it carried became part of His spirit. He was made to be sin. That is where your redemption came from.

Under the old covenant, an animal had no spirit, and its blood represented the life in it. But Jesus offered Himself through the eternal spirit.

There is nothing you cannot have, and if you do not have it, there is nothing you cannot attain to. If what preachers are preaching to you is not enough for you to access what He has, that is why Jesus said the day would come when people would worship Him in spirit, out of their born-again spirit, and in truth, because they have a capacity to believe that truth.

Love Turns Worship Away From Manipulation and Toward Mission

There is a catch. He knows that when you enter fellowship with Him through worship, you will begin to be baptized in His compassion. He knows your serving Him will not be to manipulate Him for the purposes of greed and your own life.

He knows you are going to change. Pretty soon He will have someone who will face the hardest circumstances and go where He sends. You will do anything He asks.

Because you are walking in His love and compassion, you will give yourself. You will receive from Him the truth of all He has for people and worship Him in that truth by bringing it to them.

Love will do that for you. You will surrender your life and lay all that you are and all you will ever be on the altar.

"I am not exactly there yet."

Then let me bring you to the front line. Not a dramatic front line somewhere far away. Let us start with private worship.

If you would like, I could put a ninja in your prayer closet to attack you every fifteen or twenty minutes. Some people say they have been forced into prayer. Let me tell you the kind God likes best: not the kind you were forced into, but the kind where you lift your face whether things are going good or bad and tell Him how good He is.

Of course, if tribulation forces you into prayer, so be it.

Some say, "I quit praying for patience."

"Why?"

"All I got was tribulation."

That slogan went around the holiness camps. But if you were already patient, tribulation would not have come with it. Usually the reason you need patience is because you have a thick skull. When you ask Him for patience, He tries to give it to you, and you get impatient and start striving in the wrong direction. That is where you hit most of your problems.

Even Roman-tempered iron is no match against private worship. Learn to wield the high-carbon steel of worship. Not even jail can hold you. Ask Peter.

If steel bars cannot hold you, I feel sorry for your little trial.

Keep Coming Because Everything Is Moving Toward the Promise

I am not talking to you this morning just to stir you. When He grabs you, you leave inspired to go back into private worship.

Nobody has to coerce you. You are a free, wandering soul under the discipline of your own spirit. What we do, we do because we are motivated to do it.

You may have something you need to do, or maybe you need to rest, but you know the walk of the Spirit now. Be self-governed.

I have it from a good source: everything is coming. It is close enough to grab a star. It is coming. It is coming. He has received authority for it, and that part of the fight has been received.

So come when you can.

Hallelujah.